NORDIC FOOD TOURISM 2026-2027

Desk research report

Current state, challenges and starting points

Outcome 1.1

Working draft, October 2026

Administrative body: Visit Denmark
Partners: the eight Nordic tourism organisations and food sector organisations
Funded by the Nordic Council of Ministers and the participating organisations

Contents

Executive summary 3

1. Introduction and background 5

A strong legacy with unrealised potential . . . 5
Defining food tourism . . . 6
Building on previous Nordic work . . . 6
The project and this report . . . 6

2. Method and scope 8

2.1 The purpose of this report . . . 8
2.2 Where the report stops . . . 8
2.3 How the material was gathered . . . 8
2.4 Scope and limitations . . . 9

3. Current state of Nordic food tourism 10

3.1 The Nordic backdrop: the region, the manifesto and the New Nordic Food programme 11
3.2 Sweden . . . 12
3.3 Norway . . . 13
3.4 Finland . . . 15
3.5 Denmark . . . 17
3.6 Iceland . . . 18
3.7 Åland . . . 19
3.8 The Faroe Islands . . . 21
3.9 Greenland . . . 22
3.10 Sápmi . . . 23
3.11 The dominant Nordic narrative today . . . 24

4. Challenges and potentials for the project 26

4.1 Strategy and policy . . . 26
4.2 Incentives . . . 26

4.3 Preconditions 27
4.4 Different starting points for a shared narrative 28
4.5 Challenges for the project 29
4.6 Potentials for the project 30

5. Recommendations from earlier projects **31**

6. Conclusions, gaps and starting points **32**

6.1 What the mapping shows 32
6.2 Starting points for the project 32

Appendix: References **34**

Executive summary

Nordic Food Tourism 2026-2027 brings the eight Nordic tourism organisations together with the food sector. This report is the project's desk research, its first deliverable (Outcome 1.1). It maps where Nordic food tourism stands today. It draws lessons from earlier Nordic work. And it gives the background for the way forward.

The report covers all eight Nordic countries and territories, plus Sápmi. It rests on open sources and on a review by each national partner. The picture is drawn as of autumn 2026.

Five findings stand out.

- **Strategic maturity differs.** Five of the eight have a food tourism strategy or a funded national initiative. The others work with food through tourism strategies and brand platforms instead.
- **Food and tourism are organised very differently.** Norway has fused them. Elsewhere they sit in two or three separate homes. That changes who the project can work with at national level.
- **The countries need a shared narrative in different ways.** Some already have a strong national food identity. Others are barely visible abroad. Both the project and the later implementation have to be adapted to that.
- **The food traveller is worth more where it has been measured.** Norway's and Denmark's food travellers spend more than other visitors. In Finland, food is among the strongest drivers of destination choice. No shared Nordic evidence base exists yet.
- **Much of the work never crosses a border.** The countries rarely hear what the others are doing.

What follows for the project.

One principle runs through everything. Every project activity must have a practical use. The project is responsible for making it usable for all eight.

- **A narrative that fits different needs.** The shared narrative (Outcome 1.3) has to work for partners at very different starting points. It must add something where a national food identity is already strong. And it must lift those who are barely visible abroad.
- **A catalogue of good examples.** The catalogue (Outcome 1.4) is a separate deliverable about product development. It gathers good examples from across the region, so partners can learn from each other.
- **A digital home.** The project and its deliverables need one place to live. It secures follow-through after the project period. It also gives every partner fair and equal access to

the work.

- **A network that meets around it.** The networking activities (Outcome 1.2) are where the partners work on this together.

What is still open. No shared Nordic evidence base on the food traveller exists yet. Building one would give every partner a stronger case at home.

1. Introduction and background

A strong legacy with unrealised potential

Nordic food tourism builds on a strong legacy. The New Nordic Kitchen Manifesto (2004) reshaped the international perception of Nordic cuisine, and over the past two decades chefs from Denmark, Norway, Sweden and Iceland have added to that reputation through a long series of Bocuse d'Or medals (Project application, 2026). Yet the region's culinary strength extends far beyond fine dining and Michelin-starred restaurants. High-quality, local and seasonal food experiences are found throughout the Nordic region, in everyday settings and rural communities. What is missing is the cross-border part: today these experiences are mostly promoted country by country, with no shared Nordic story and no joint itineraries for travellers to follow between them. That is the specific potential this project sets out to unlock.

Working together across borders and sectors around food exists fragmentarily in the Nordic region. Yet it matters more than ever. Self-sufficiency and preparedness have drawn renewed attention (Project application, 2026). Where the cross-border work does exist, it is worth looking at closely. One example is M.A.T., a food tourism collaboration between Värmland and Norway (Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.). It is exactly the kind of case this project should learn from. Chapter 3 returns to it.

This report is the first deliverable of the Nordic Food Tourism 2026-2027 project. And it is deliberately a starting point rather than a conclusion. It gathers what is already known, shows where the Nordic region stands today, names the challenges the countries share, weighs the conditions that set them apart, and draws together what earlier initiatives have already recommended. It is not a final report, and it leaves the project's own catalogue of recommended product development ideas, and a new Nordic Food Tourism narrative, to a later stage (Project application, 2026).

Defining food tourism

Food tourism means different things to different people, and it is worth being explicit about the scope this report uses, since it applies equally across all eight Nordic countries and territories. The World Food Travel Association defines it as travelling for "a taste of place". The purpose is "to gain a deeper sense of place" (World Food Travel Association, what is food tourism). The association is not a formal authority like UN Tourism. But it has worked in the field for many years. Food tourism covers the full spectrum of food-related travel motivations: fine dining and Michelin-starred restaurants at one end, but just as much regional dishes and culinary traditions, farm shops and producers, food markets, and the wider range of everyday food experiences that shape a destination. In line with the project's own emphasis on "local-everyday-food-experiences" (Project application, 2026), this report leans towards the everyday end of that spectrum without excluding the gastronomic one. Each country section in chapter 3 reflects where that country's own emphasis currently falls within it.

Building on previous Nordic work

The project does not begin from a blank page. It takes off from the Icelandic-led *Nordic Food in Tourism 2019-2021* project, supported by the Nordic Council of Ministers, whose final report set out a common vision and strategic guidelines for future implementation (Matís, *Nordic Food in Future Tourism*, 2022). It also aligns closely with the ongoing *New Nordic Food 2025-2027* programme, funded by EK-FJLS (Project application, 2026). A central purpose of this report is to make that inheritance explicit, so that the project builds on established insight rather than repeating it.

During the Danish Presidency of the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2026, all eight Nordic National Tourism Organisations decided to take part jointly in the Nordic Food Week leading up to the launch of the Nordic Michelin Guide 2026. They also agreed that the collaboration should extend beyond a single event, establishing a longer-term cooperation between the tourism and food sectors, with a shared point of departure at the World Travel Market in London in 2026 and 2027 (Project application, 2026).

The project and this report

Nordic Food Tourism 2026-2027 is administered by Visit Denmark and funded by the Nordic Council of Ministers together with the Nordic tourism organisations. It runs from May 2026 to December 2027 and aims to unite all eight Nordic National Tourism Organisations with key actors in the food sector around common food tourism development and a shared Nordic food tourism narrative (Project application, 2026).

This report delivers the project's first activity (Outcome 1.1): desk research mapping Nordic food tourism activities, its challenges and its potentials, in relation to strategic Nordic

priorities (Project application, 2026). It sits within the Nordic Tourism Plan 2025-2030 and its three pillars, Innovative Nordics, Competitive Nordics and Attractive Nordics, where collaboration with the food sector is named directly under Attractive Nordics (Project application, 2026; Nordic Tourism Plan 2025-2030). From here, the report moves through the method and scope, then a country-by-country picture of where Nordic food tourism stands today, before drawing the countries together into what their strategies, incentives and conditions mean for the project. It closes with the recommendations worth carrying forward from earlier work, and the gaps and starting points the project can build on.

2. Method and scope

2.1 The purpose of this report

This report is a starting point for the project. It has three jobs. It maps where Nordic food tourism stands today. It draws lessons from earlier Nordic initiatives. And it gives the background for the way forward for the Nordic Food Tourism project 2026-2027.

The audience is the project itself. That means the project team, the steering group and the eight National Tourism Organisations. It also means the food sector partners we aim to carry the work with. This is a working document for the people who will do the work. Like everything in the project, it must be of practical use.

Its findings are meant to travel further. Once the picture is settled, the project can take those findings outward. There they serve a different purpose. They explain to stakeholders what the project will do, and what happens next.

2.2 Where the report stops

It is worth being clear about where this report stops. Not to limit it, but so that everyone knows what to expect.

The report gathers and interprets. It does not yet develop. Readers looking for methods, tools or how-tos will find them further along. That is what the catalogue of product development ideas (Outcome 1.4) is for. The shared Nordic narrative (Outcome 1.3) follows the same path. This report lays the ground they will be built on.

2.3 How the material was gathered

The work rests on two sources.

The first is open material. This includes national strategies, policy documents and the tourism organisations' own publications. It also includes earlier Nordic project reports, funding calls, press material and news coverage. Everything used is listed in the reference appendix. Where a claim could not be verified in open sources, the report says so directly.

The second is the project's own network. Each of the eight countries has a contact person for this project. Their positions vary. Some sit in the national tourism organisation. Others sit in a food organisation, a public agency or a research institution. Where the open material was thin, these contacts filled the gaps. Each country also reviewed its own national section before publication.

AI has been used as a working tool in this process. It helped structure the material and process the text. The research direction, the choice of sources and the conclusions are the project's own.

2.4 Scope and limitations

The report covers all eight Nordic countries and autonomous territories: Denmark, Sweden, Norway, Finland, Iceland, the Faroe Islands, Greenland and Åland, plus the Sápmi region. The time frame runs from the New Nordic Kitchen Manifesto in 2004 to autumn 2026. The emphasis is on what is happening now, and on what is about to happen.

Three limitations follow from this method.

First, coverage is uneven. Countries with mature strategies leave a longer paper trail than those without. That difference shows in the length of the country sections. It reflects the available material, not the ambition of the country.

Second, open sources age quickly. Strategies, budgets and initiatives will change during a project of this length. The picture drawn here is the picture as of autumn 2026.

Third, this report does not reproduce each country's own food narrative. It describes the shared picture in 3.11. Building one Nordic narrative is the task of Outcome 1.3.

3. Current state of Nordic food tourism

Food tourism is growing fast across the Nordic region. But its scale and shape differ by country and region. This chapter starts with the shared Nordic foundation. Then it maps each country in turn. The order is Sweden, Norway, Finland, Denmark, Iceland, Åland, the Faroe Islands, Greenland and Sápmi.

Every country or region is read through the same lens. How is the tourism organisation set up? Where does food sit within it? What is the national strategy and policy status? Who are the national stakeholders and partners? And what initiatives are worth knowing about?

Initiatives split into two groups. Some are ongoing, useful for synergy. Others came before, useful for lessons. Chapter 5 picks up those lessons again.

At a glance. Where the eight stand today, before the detail.

Country	Strategy or policy basis	Where food sits	Funding or target
Sweden	No separate one. Food tourism sits in Food Strategy 2.0	Many bodies; Visit Sweden markets	SEK 40 million call, to 2028. Largest investments are regional
Norway	Matnasjonen Norge (2021)	Innovation Norway, one body	No separate line. Target of NOK 25 billion by 2035
Finland	Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028	Visit Finland markets, Hungry for Finland develops	EUR 2 million, 2025-2027
Denmark	Priority within the tourism strategy	Visit Denmark with food organisations	Maddestinationer 2.0, to 2027
Iceland	None. Food culture in Tourism Strategy 2030	Business Iceland, two separate sectors	ISK 15 million a year, culture as a whole
Åland	Smakturismstrategi 2025-2030	Högskolan på Åland owns it; Visit Åland markets	EU co-financing, to 2027
The Faroe Islands	None. One of five brand pillars	Visit Faroe Islands, no food unit	Not confirmed
Greenland	None. Food sits in the tourism strategy	Visit Greenland, no food unit	Not confirmed
Sápmi	None. Ethical frameworks already exist	Sámi Parliaments and the Saami Council	Grant scheme at Sametinget in Norway

3.1 The Nordic backdrop: the region, the manifesto and the New Nordic Food programme

A region the world struggles to name. Nordic co-operation spans Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Sweden, the Faroe Islands, Greenland and Åland. Sápmi, the Sámi cultural region, crosses four of these areas. Internationally, this eight-part region is far less established than it is at home. The common international shorthand remains Scandinavia. That term is a nineteenth-century construct covering Sweden, Norway and Denmark. Finland and Iceland often fall outside it. The three self-governing areas rarely feature at all.

Part of the explanation is institutional. The Nordic label was largely built from within. Föreningen Norden (1919), the Nordic Council (1952) and the Helsinki Treaty (1962) shaped it. The self-governing areas gained formal representation late. The Faroe Islands and Åland joined the Nordic Council in 1970, Greenland in 1984. Part of the explanation is structural. International statistics, rankings and brand surveys are organised around sovereign states. The three self-governing areas therefore disappear into Denmark and Finland in most international data. Brand Finance's Global Soft Power Index, for example, only measures UN member states (Brand Finance, Global Soft Power Index, 2026). Visit Finland's 2025 image study covered five Nordic countries, not eight areas (Visit Finland, image study 2025).

The same state logic explains many knowledge gaps in this chapter. Open sources simply document the self-governing areas less. No recent open study measures which areas international audiences count as the Nordic region. That is a genuine knowledge gap, and chapter 6 returns to it. How the project should respond to it is a narrative question. Designing the shared narrative is a later project activity (Outcome 1.3).

Beyond the region's name, the countries share a common foundation: the New Nordic Food Manifesto.

The manifesto (2004). The New Nordic Food Manifesto was written in Copenhagen in 2004 (New Nordic Food Manifesto, 2004). Twelve chefs signed it, representing Denmark, Norway, Sweden, Finland, Iceland, Greenland, the Faroe Islands and Åland. That full Nordic span is why it still works as common ground today (Nordic cooperation, New Nordic Food). It reshaped how the region tells the story of its food.

The New Nordic Food programme. The manifesto continues today as a programme under the Nordic Council of Ministers. The current phase, New Nordic Food 2025-2027, is run by the Danish organisation Madkulturen. It is funded through the food sector of Nordic co-operation (EK-FJLS) (Project application, 2026; Nordic cooperation, New Nordic Food).

Twenty years on. A 2024 analysis by Madkulturen took stock of the manifesto's impact (Madkulturen, Ny nordisk mad, 2024). Two findings matter for this project. First, the movement genuinely transformed fine dining, and Nordic Michelin stars have multiplied since 2004. Second, "New Nordic" rhymes poorly with everyday food. Outside Denmark the

term is not widely known. Local ingredients have made far less headway in supermarkets, canteens and everyday cooking. The representation was real, but it ran through chefs. The movement's reach has stayed concentrated in gastronomy ever since. That gap between high-end recognition and everyday relevance is where this project works.

Why it matters here. New Nordic Food is the food sector's Nordic programme whilst Nordic Food Tourism is the tourism sector's. The two sit on either side of the same table, and the goal of this project is to bring them together. That makes New Nordic Food 2025-2027 the single most important current Nordic-level initiative to align with, and the project application names it explicitly as a programme to ensure synergy with (Project application, 2026).

3.2 Sweden

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Swedish food tourism starts with the national food strategy. It has been built up since 2010 and was updated in 2025. The update has three priorities. Robustness across the whole food chain, export promotion, and Swedish quality and gastronomy (Visit Sweden, national section review, 2026). Visit Sweden's role follows from it. Visit Sweden is tasked with marketing food tourism and spreading knowledge about it (Visit Sweden, 2025-2027 assignment). Visit Sweden has been wholly state-owned since 2020 (Visit Sweden becomes a wholly state-owned company, 2020). It operates under the Ministry of Climate and Enterprise. Food tourism does not sit in a body of its own. It runs through the knowledge and analysis remit funded via Jordbruksverket.

National strategy and policy status. Sweden has among the most developed policy frameworks in the Nordic region. Food tourism (måltidsturism) is treated as part of the food value chain within the national food strategy (adopted 2017, running to 2030) and its successor phase, Food Strategy 2.0 (2025-2030), under the strategic area of Consumer and Market (Jordbruksverket, food strategy; Visit Sweden, action plan 2022). The export programme for food tourism 2017-2022 concluded with a national action plan for Swedish food tourism, and Visit Sweden now holds a multi-year knowledge and analysis assignment for 2025-2027, forwarded as a subsidy by Jordbruksverket, focused on spreading knowledge to the tourism industry (Visit Sweden, 2025-2027 assignment; Jordbruksverket, food tourism).

National stakeholders and partners. The landscape is broad and cross-sectoral. Central actors include Visit Sweden (destination marketing), Jordbruksverket (funding and coordination), Livsmedelsverket, Tillväxtverket, SLU, Business Sweden, and industry bodies such as LRF and Livsmedelsföretagen, several of which sit in the food strategy's coordination structure (Jordbruksverket, food strategy; Tillväxtverket, coordination). Tillväxtverket has a national and regional coordination role. It coordinates public bodies and industry, and follows up the strategy's goals (Tillväxtverket, coordination; Visit Sweden, national section review, 2026). At regional level, work is carried by regions, county administrative boards

(länsstyrelser) and green clusters, and by established regional initiatives such as Hallands Matgille, Sörmlands Matkluster, Visit Skåne and others.

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). Regional projects carry much of the current work. Most are funded through EU regional funds, often together with regional bodies. Examples are M.A.T. in Värmland, Hallands Matgille in Halland, and Lokal Gastronomi Dalarna (Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.; Tillväxtverket, Hallands Matgille; Visit Sweden, national section review, 2026). Comparable work runs in other regions as well. Tillväxtverket's project bank lists them (Tillväxtverket, project bank).

Two national efforts run alongside these. Visit Sweden's knowledge and analysis assignment 2025-2027 is funded as a subsidy via Jordbruksverket (Visit Sweden, 2025-2027 assignment). The Swedish Board of Agriculture announced a SEK 40 million call in 2024. It funds collaboration projects in two parts. A national part of SEK 10 million develops a toolkit for place development. A regional part of SEK 30 million funds five to six implementation projects. All are to be completed by 15 January 2028 (Jordbruksverket, food tourism call). These share themes with the Nordic project: place development, local food and international marketing.

Previous initiatives. The largest investments have been regional, not national. EU regional funds and the county administrative boards have carried most of them (Visit Sweden, national section review, 2026; Tillväxtverket, project bank). The export programme for food tourism 2017-2022 ran at national level. It concluded with the national action plan for Swedish food tourism (Visit Sweden, food tourism programme 2017-2022).

3.3 Norway

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Norway is unusual in that tourism and local food live under the same roof. Innovation Norway is both the national tourism organisation and the body that supports agriculture-based business, including small-scale local food and drink producers (Innovation Norway, local food and experiences). That gives food a natural home next to tourism, and it means the project has, in Innovation Norway, a single Norwegian partner that already bridges both sectors, exactly the kind of cross-sector link the Nordic project is built around. Innovation Norway's own figures show that greater use of local food adds real value for the tourism industry (Innovation Norway, local food and experiences).

National strategy and policy status. Norway has a clear, government-backed framework. The Matnasjonen Norge strategy (2021) comes from three ministries. Agriculture and Food, Trade and Industry, and Health and Care Services. It sets a vision for 2030. Food should be a source of joy, pride, health and community. And a visible part of Norway as a tourist country, built around four focus areas (Matnasjonen Norge, 2021). It runs alongside the national tourism strategy, and earlier Nordic work singled the two out as a rare case of food and

tourism strategies deliberately reinforcing one another (Matís, Nordic Food in Future Tourism, 2022).

What the food traveller looks like. Innovation Norway's Tourism Survey 2025 puts numbers on the opportunity. Four in ten foreign leisure visitors are interested in food experiences. They are a distinct and more valuable segment. Food tourists spend 1 965 kroner a day, against 1 775 for leisure visitors overall. More of them are first-time visitors, 55 per cent against 47. They also rate the trip higher, with a net promoter score of 76 against 73. Asked what they actually did, 74 per cent point to experiencing the food culture. A special dish follows at 40 per cent, a particular restaurant at 30. Germany, the United States and the United Kingdom are the largest markets. Interest drops in the winter season (Innovation Norway, Tourism Survey 2025).

National stakeholders and partners. Innovation Norway is the central actor, working with HANEN, the national industry organisation for rural tourism and local food producers, and with the county governors (Statsforvalteren) on local food regionally, under the Ministry of Agriculture and Food. Regional producer cooperatives are also part of the landscape (HANEN, projects).

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). Innovation Norway is backing a 2025 pilot to bring more Norwegian local food into public procurement, run through the cooperative Mat og drikke fra Innlandet SA, which links ten actors across agriculture, tourism and food (Innovation Norway, local food pilot 2025). HANEN is taking Norwegian local food and tourism to the Internationale Grüne Woche in Berlin in 2026, the fair's hundredth anniversary, with twenty members and students from the Norwegian Restaurant School, an international showcase that sits close to the Nordic project's own B2B and press ambitions (HANEN, IGW 2026). And the cross-border M.A.T. project is directly relevant here. The name stands for Måltidsupplevelser, Autenticitet & Tradition. It is run by Visit Värmland and Visit Øst-Norge (Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.). This is an existing Nordic cross-border collaboration to learn from and build on. Over all of this sits the ongoing work to deliver Matnasjonen Norge towards 2030 (Matnasjonen Norge, 2021).

**Previous initiatives.

3.4 Finland

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Finland's national tourism organisation is Visit Finland. It is the tourism unit within Business Finland, which promotes export, investment and innovation. Visit Finland is not a separate company, unlike Visit Denmark or Visit Sweden. It operates as a dedicated function inside Business Finland. Food tourism development has a second home. Hungry for Finland (H4F) is the food tourism development unit at Haaga-Helia University of Applied Sciences. It builds and coordinates the national food tourism network and provides research and education. Much of this work runs through temporary, EU-funded projects. These projects run the national competition and produce practical tools (Finland's Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028; Visit Finland, national section review, 2026). H4F has no marketing role. Its role is development and competence building. The roles meet in practice. H4F's project manager is also a food tourism trainer in the Visit Finland Academy. Visit Finland takes part in the national network meetings and in some project activities (Visit Finland, national section review, 2026). So food has a marketing home in Visit Finland and a development engine in H4F.

National strategy and policy status. Finland has one of the most developed and longest-running frameworks in the region. Its Food Tourism Strategy 2020-2028, recently refreshed as the 2024-2028 strategy, is coordinated by H4F and organised around seven action areas: sustainable business, data-driven management, product development, network-based activities, sales and accessibility, communication and marketing, and sharpening regional food tourism identities (Finland's Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028). The update was thorough, drawing on sixteen workshops, a current-state analysis, expert interviews and input from entrepreneurs, which says a good deal about how embedded the network approach is.

National stakeholders and partners. Visit Finland and Hungry for Finland are the core actors. The Ministry of Agriculture and Forestry is a key funder. The work runs through regional core groups across the country. They include Lapland, Central Finland, Saimaa, Southwest Finland and Satakunta. Others are North Ostrobothnia, Greater Helsinki, and Kanta-Häme and Päijät-Häme (Finland's Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028). These groups are active in development. Not all of them work on international markets. In marketing, four regions have come furthest. They are Turku and the archipelago, and the Helsinki and Tampere regions. The fourth is Savonlinna and Mikkeli, in the Lake Saimaa region (Visit Finland, national section review, 2026).

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). Visit Finland's food image project runs from 2025 to 31 December 2027. The Ministry of Agriculture and Forestry funds it. The total budget is EUR 2 million over three years. It targets Germany, France and the USA, with Spain and Japan as additional markets. The work is mainly image marketing: campaigns, PR, social media and own websites. It also includes market-specific activities and tools for stakeholders.

There is also cooperation with destination management organisations (DMOs) (Visit Finland, food image project 2025-2027; Visit Finland, national section review, 2026). It maps closely onto this project's aim: a stronger international profile for Nordic food.

The Hungry for Finland Food Tourism Competition 2026 is running its next round. Entries came in early in 2026, and winners are named in September (Hungry for Finland, competition 2026). A new national project starts in the coming months. H4F coordinates it, and five parties take part in total. Its focus is the regional core groups. Some groups still exist and some do not, but all will be activated. The project has five strands. National coordination of the regional networks, and of regional projects. Sharing best practice and tools. Better digitalisation in food tourism companies. And using Finnish food culture in tourism products (Visit Finland, national section review, 2026). The national network counts 1,550 people. About 270 are active and take part in meetings. The core groups meet once or twice a year, online and in person (Visit Finland, national section review, 2026).

Market research. The food image project has produced its first measurable output. Visit Finland commissioned a baseline image study, published in 2025. Fieldwork ran in July 2025 across five markets. Germany, Spain, France, the USA and Japan. The sample was 5,060 travellers aged 18 to 65. All were planning a leisure trip within three years. The study also serves as a baseline for monitoring attractiveness over time (Visit Finland, image study 2025).

Four findings matter beyond Finland. First, food ranks second among all travel themes globally. Food experiences and local delicacies drew 59 per cent interest. Only beautiful nature scored higher, at 61 per cent. Interest in local food is close to universal. 87 per cent want food made from local ingredients and traditions. Second, food drives destination choice for Finland specifically. Interesting culinary experiences ranked third among the attributes driving consideration. Interesting Nordic culture and way of life ranked first. Third, Finland trails the other Nordic countries on consideration. 37 per cent of travellers would consider a holiday there. Sweden reached 47 per cent, Norway 46, Iceland 45 and Denmark 41. Fourth, Finnish food is barely known abroad. Respondents associate fish, naturalness and simplicity with Finland. Beyond that the cuisine is largely unfamiliar. The study notes that this unfamiliarity produces curiosity rather than resistance (Visit Finland, image study 2025).

The study separates Finland's established strengths from its development points. Nordic and Arctic flavours, pure nature, wild foods and fresh game are established. Pastries and a relaxed, uncomplicated dining culture are named as development areas. The experiences travellers most want are strikingly ordinary. Local markets and market halls, local cuisine, and local specialities at breakfast (Visit Finland, image study 2025).

Previous initiatives. The original Food Tourism Strategy 2020-2028 and the earlier rounds of Hungry for Finland built the foundation for today's network.

3.5 Denmark

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Visit Denmark is the country's national tourism organisation and the administrative body for this project. It has put food close to the centre of its work. Gastronomy is one of its three core narratives. Its current strategy (2023-2026) is titled "Tourism we can live from and live with, towards 2030". It treats food as a headline reason to visit (Visit Denmark, strategy 2023-2026). The numbers back this up. In 2025, 41 per cent of all tourists chose Denmark partly for the food. That includes dining out and gastronomy more broadly. These gastro-tourists also spend noticeably more per day than the average guest. That is exactly why Visit Denmark and the destination companies lean into it (Visit Denmark, food and gastro tourists, 2025).

National strategy and policy status. Food tourism is not an afterthought in Denmark. It is a stated priority within the national tourism strategy. That priority is carried through campaigns and destination partnerships. There is no single standalone food-tourism strategy (Visit Denmark, strategy 2023-2026). The approach has matured over several years. It began with an early gastronomy push in 2019 from the Ministry of Agriculture. Today it is broader, story-led work on Denmark as a food country. The former Minister of Tourism even established a national Gastro Advisory Board. The board proposed a long-term food initiative with a budget of DKK 40 million. But the change of government means a new minister must consider the plan and budget.

National stakeholders and partners. Visit Denmark is responsible for all international marketing of food tourism. The 19 destinations handle domestic marketing, though not all of them focus on food. The three tourism development agencies cover nature tourism, city tourism and business tourism. They have run food programmes irregularly, usually integrated into other programmes. On the food side, Denmark has a long list of national organisations. FOOD Organisation of Denmark organises food events in Denmark. FoodNation organises food events with the embassies abroad and receives delegations in Denmark. Landbrug & Fødevarer represents the food and agriculture industry, lobbying for and promoting the sector. Bocuse d'Or Denmark is another example. Denmark is also the operational home of the Nordic-level New Nordic Food programme. It is run by the Danish organisation Madkulturen. The programme is described in the Nordic backdrop in section 3.1.

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). The one to watch is Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0 (2024-2027). It is funded by the Danish Business Promotion Board (Danmarks Erhvervsfremmebestyrelse). The project does three things at once. It markets Denmark abroad. It builds a shared national core narrative for Denmark as a food destination. Partners can adapt that narrative into their own local stories. And it develops local food events in the five participating destinations. The focus is on sustainable meals from local produce. It also ties food to the landscape it comes from. Think shellfish from the Limfjord and wild herbs from Møn. It also includes a new Visit Denmark campaign for the Norwegian and German

markets (Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0). For the Nordic project this is an obvious point of synergy. Denmark is already doing nationally much of what this project wants to do across borders. Namely, building a shared food narrative.

Previous initiatives. Denmark's earlier gastronomy initiative laid the groundwork for today's work. That was the Gastro 2025 effort of 2019-2022. The campaign told local food stories through eleven short videos. They gathered some 141 million views (Visit Denmark, Gastro 2025, 2019-2022). Earlier this year the Minister of Culture made a first move (Falstaff, 2026). The aim is to recognise gastronomy as an artistic discipline. That expands both how to work with gastronomy and how to make policy around it. It happened at a five-day event in Copenhagen. Rasmus Munk and his team at Alchemist hosted it. The event advocated collaboration and knowledge-sharing among more than sixty of the world's best chefs. It engaged both public and private entities. It also generated more than 400 million impressions through various media coverage (Alchemist, press report).

3.6 Iceland

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Iceland's promotion body is Business Iceland (Íslandsstofa). It is a public-private partnership with a seven-person board. Ministers and the Confederation of Icelandic Employers appoint its members (Business Iceland, Act). Business Iceland brands and markets Iceland and its export industries. It supports companies in foreign markets and facilitates foreign investment. Tourism and Fisheries & Food are listed as separate export sectors (Business Iceland, about). Visit Iceland is one of its marketing projects. Food and tourism therefore sit in one organisation, but not in one remit. Alongside Business Iceland sits Ferðamálastofa, the Icelandic Tourist Board. It is a separate government body for licensing, regulation and statistics (Ferðamálastofa, about us). The division of labour is clear in practice. Business Iceland works with international communication and strategy. The Icelandic Tourist Board works with national and local initiatives (Business Iceland, national section review, 2026).

National strategy and policy status. Iceland has no dedicated food tourism strategy. But food culture has an explicit place in national tourism policy. Iceland's Tourism Strategy 2030 sets out action E.1, running 2024 to 2030. It calls for culture to become one of two main pillars, alongside nature. Food culture is named as part of official tourism promotion. Business Iceland is the implementing organisation (Iceland, Tourism Strategy 2030). Actions C.1 and C.2 point the same way. They stress Iceland's cultural character and authentic visitor experiences (Iceland, Tourism Strategy 2030). Visit Iceland is also updating its communication strategy. Food will be included specifically, both as food tourism and as cultural experience (Business Iceland, national section review, 2026).

National stakeholders and partners. Business Iceland and the Icelandic Tourist Board are the two national bodies. The strategy also names regional destination management

organisations as platforms for cooperation. They bring together government, municipalities, tourism businesses and other stakeholders (Iceland, Tourism Strategy 2030). A formal stakeholder analysis for this project has not yet been made. The partner expects to build wider collaboration as the project proceeds. Relevant groups include the Ministry of Industries and tourism businesses offering food experiences. Restaurants, food producers and organisations promoting Icelandic cuisine also belong there. This is an initial outline, not a confirmed partner list (Business Iceland, national section review, 2026).

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). Visit Iceland takes an "always-on" approach to food communication. Food is woven into stories about ingredients, greenhouses, restaurants and local produce. Cooperation between the Tourism and Food sectors at Business Iceland is also developing. It extends food communication into new areas and connects the two sectors. Business Iceland has taken an active part in building this Nordic collaboration. That includes contributing to the shared Nordic narrative (Business Iceland, national section review, 2026).

Iceland also joined preparations for a joint Nordic initiative in Copenhagen. It was linked to Nordic Food Week and the Michelin Guide in June 2026. Several Nordic countries plan a shared stand at World Travel Market (WTM) in London, November 2026. Iceland has decided not to join that stand this year. It will consider 2027 once the 2026 experience is available (Business Iceland, national section review, 2026).

Previous initiatives. Iceland led the Nordic Food in Tourism 2019-2021 project. Its final report shaped the vision and strategic guidelines this project builds on (Matís, Nordic Food in Future Tourism, 2022). The work ended with a conference at Hotel Valaskjálf on 30 September 2021. It presented three years of work on Nordic cuisine and sustainable food tourism. Austurbrú's Matarmót followed the next day, with East Iceland food producers (Business Iceland, Matarferðaþjónusta, 2021). More recently, Taste of Iceland came to London in September 2026. It presented Icelandic culture and export products, including food (Business Iceland, Taste of Iceland London, 2026).

3.7 Åland

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Visit Åland is the destination organisation for Åland. The islands are self-governing. It works closely with Visit Finland. That cooperation is described as continuing to bear fruit (Visit Åland, cooperation with Visit Finland). Food work is spread across three homes rather than one. Ålands Landsbygdscentrum leads the food strategy from the rural development side. Högskolan på Åland owns the current taste tourism project. Visit Åland handles destination marketing (Åland, national section review, 2026).

National strategy and policy status. Åland has two relevant strategies, not one. The first is Ålands hållbara livsmedelsstrategi, the sustainable food strategy. Ålands Producentförbund produced it in 2017, working with several other organisations (Åland, national section review,

2026). Its vision was to become the Baltic Sea's leading gastronomic island, sustainable and future-ready. Local food production was positioned as a core asset for destination attractiveness and pilot development (Åland, food strategy, EU tourism platform summary). Locally produced food and drink were framed as strengthening the Åland brand (EU tourism platform, Åland food tourism). The partner now describes that strategy as out of date. Ålands landskapsregering is currently revising it, led by the agriculture office (Åland, national section review, 2026). What the revised strategy will say about food and taste tourism is not yet known.

The second strategy is newer and more directly relevant to this project. Ålands Smakturismstrategi 2025-2030 is a dedicated taste tourism strategy. It was produced by the project Smakturismen på Åland, which runs 2024-2027. Högskolan på Åland owns that project, and the EU co-finances it (Åland, national section review, 2026). Åland therefore has a food tourism strategy of its own, separate from the food strategy.

National stakeholders and partners. Ålands Landsbygdscentrum leads the food strategy work. Ålands Producentförbund produced that strategy and sits within the centre. Högskolan på Åland owns the Smakturismen på Åland project and contributes research (Högskolan på Åland, projects). Visit Åland handles destination marketing and works with Visit Finland. Skördefestens vänner is a further central actor, organising the Skördefesten harvest festival (Åland, national section review, 2026).

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). Two projects are running now. Smakturismen på Åland runs 2024-2027 and produced the taste tourism strategy. DigiMat runs 2024-2027 alongside it (Åland, national section review, 2026). The sustainable food strategy is live as well. Ålands Landsbygdscentrum publishes regular updates under the heading "på gång just nu" (Ålands Landsbygdscentrum, food strategy news).

Skördefesten deserves separate mention. The three-day harvest festival is run by the association Skördefestens vänner. A recent edition passed one million in sales. Many Åland food producers are members and take part in the event. It sells Åland products only. The partner describes it as a strong driver of how food on Åland developed (Åland, national section review, 2026).

Åland wants to be seen as a pioneer in sustainable, healthy food systems. The ambition is explicitly framed against other Nordic self-governing regions. That makes Åland a natural voice in the project's Nordic-level conversation (EU tourism platform, Åland food tourism).

Previous initiatives. Åland has a long run of food-related projects behind it. Skärgårdssmak (1996-2004), Rural Lifestyle (2014-2022), Kustens mat (2016-2019), MatÅland (2017-2022), Hungry for Saltvik (2019-2021) and Axganmat på evenemang och restauranger (2020-2022) (Åland, national section review, 2026). The partner notes the list may not be complete. That is a longer project history than the desk research alone suggested.

3.8 The Faroe Islands

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Visit Faroe Islands is the national tourist board. It sits under the Ministry of Trade and Industry. Its mandate is to develop and market the islands as a destination (Visit Faroe Islands, about us). Food has no organisational unit of its own. But it is far from a side theme. Food is one of five brand pillars in Visit Faroe Islands' brand book. It has long been central to storytelling, especially in PR and press visits (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026).

National strategy and policy status. The relevant strategic document is HEIM: Tourism Strategy towards 2030, launched in 2023. It sets out a vision for sustainable, balanced tourism in harmony with local communities (Visit Faroe Islands, tourism strategy 2030). There is no explicit food tourism strategy. Food tourism is nonetheless growing, and it is a strategic focus area in product development. Visit Faroe Islands sees food as a driver of tourism development. It also sees food as a driver of food security and pride. Revitalising traditional Faroese food is part of that picture (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026).

National stakeholders and partners. Visit Faroe Islands is the clear national actor. The Faroe Islands are also home to NORA (Nordic Atlantic Cooperation), led by Halla Nolsø Poulsen. Earlier Nordic work names Graskarasetrið iNOVA as a Faroese partner organisation (Matís, Nordic Food in Future Tourism, 2022). iNOVA now houses Mat- og tilfeingishúsið, a new food and resource centre. It gives professional guidance on food production and processing (Mat- og tilfeingishúsið, iNOVA).

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). Several initiatives are running, even without a food tourism strategy. Nýskapan í Ferðavinnu is an annual accelerator for new tourism projects. Visit Faroe Islands runs it with Húskotið and Visit Tórshavn. For the past two years its focus has been agritourism and food as souvenirs. Since 2025 the chef school offers a full chef education. Before, it trained only ship's cooks. Training chefs at home, rather than abroad, is a political priority. Rótin in Klaksvík, a former home economics school, now works with sustainability and local resources. Veltan on Sandoy grows vegetables for households, small communities and restaurants. Heimablídni, dining in Faroese homes, is a long-running initiative that keeps developing. Norway and Greenland have shown interest, and the concept is now being tested in Norway (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026; Visit Faroe Islands, Heimablídni).

Arctic Young Chefs runs across Greenland, Iceland, the Faroe Islands and Norway. Since 2026 the restaurant schools in each country run it, with NORA as co-funder. Visit Faroe Islands does not work with it directly. But it promotes the programme, for awareness of underused produce and for recruiting young chefs (contact list; project background; Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026).

Previous initiatives. The Faroe Islands joined Nordic Food in Tourism 2019-2021 through Graskarasetrið iNOVA. They have also taken part in the Embla Nordic Food Award (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026).

3.9 Greenland

Tourism organisation and the place of food. Visit Greenland is a limited liability company, wholly owned by the Greenland Home Rule Government (Naalakkersuisut). Founded in 1992, its mandate covers tourism, the experience industries and branding (Visit Greenland, about the organisation). It works closely with Naalakkersuisut's National Tourism Sector Plan. That plan treats tourism as a means, not an end (Visit Greenland, strategy 2025-2035). Food is not organised separately. It sits within the broader destination experience. Many Greenlandic restaurants are attached to hotels. That gives hotels an important role in developing the gastronomy offer (Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026).

National strategy and policy status. Greenland has no separate food tourism strategy. Food and gastronomy sit inside Visit Greenland's ten-year strategy (2025-2035) instead (Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026). That strategy is about tourism creating value for Greenlandic society. The guiding idea is that tourism should give more than it takes. Quality and local value weigh heavier than visitor numbers. Restaurants and gastronomy belong to that wider ecosystem. Visitor demand helps the food scene develop. This matters most where tourism is highly seasonal. The ambition is that restaurants build a local customer base in the low season. Tourism revenue then comes on top in the busier months (Visit Greenland, strategy 2025-2035).

National stakeholders and partners. Visit Greenland is the national actor, working with regional destination organisations across the country (Visit Greenland, list of DMOs). Innovation South Greenland supports local food businesses and production in the south (ISG, food). Inuili, the national food and hospitality college, builds skills in the sector (Inuili). Food festivals run in several regions, including the Disko Bay area. Visit Greenland also works with Greenlandic representations abroad around specific events (Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026).

Current initiatives (ongoing, for synergy). New Arctic Kitchen is the most directly relevant. It is a Nordic Arctic initiative connecting food and tourism, supported by NAPA. It looks for new ways to use local Arctic ingredients. It has also produced an inspiration guide for tourism operators (NAPA, New Arctic Kitchen). Greenland takes part in Arctic Young Chefs as well. In the south, Innovation South Greenland runs Mamartukuluut. It is a food brand they want to develop into a regional label (ISG, food). The Government of Greenland's business department is working on certifying locally produced products. Its status needs confirming (Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026).

Local cultivation is growing. Sisimiut Fresh Farms, founded in 2023, grows lettuce and microgreens year-round using vertical farming (Sisimiut Fresh Farms). Farmers in South Greenland are trying potatoes and strawberries as the climate warms (Forbes, Greenlandic cuisine 2025). Food is also built into press and travel trade trips. Attention to higher-end gastronomy is growing (Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026). Behind all of it sits the new airport infrastructure. Nuuk is open, with Qaqortoq and Ilulissat due in 2026. Better access should bring more visitors and support hotels and restaurants. Local value is the stated aim (Visit Greenland, strategy 2025-2035).

Previous initiatives. Greenland has run food initiatives before, though not always under a tourism banner. Nerisa, a programme built around dining with locals, is currently on pause. The Faroese restaurant Koks operated in Greenland and held Michelin stars there. It is no longer active in the country. Kommuneqarfik Sermersooq has run several Nordic food projects. That includes Greenland's part in Nordic Food in Tourism 2019-2021. South Greenland also works with food, development and branding as an innovation area (ISG, food; ISG, Inuit food report 2026; Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026).

3.10 Sápmi

Sápmi does not fit the country template used above. It is the Sámi homeland, and it crosses national borders. The Sámi are one Indigenous people living across Norway, Sweden, Finland and Russia's Kola Peninsula. This report covers the Nordic part.

A necessary caveat. Writing about the Sámi as one group is a simplification, and it needs saying plainly. There are several Sámi languages and several distinct communities. Legal status, land rights and representation differ between the three Nordic countries. Livelihoods differ too. Reindeer herding is the most visible, but most Sámi are not reindeer herders. This section therefore describes initiatives, not a culture.

Who holds the mandate. Three Sámi Parliaments speak for the Sámi in Norway, Sweden and Finland. The Saami Council works across the borders. Any Nordic food tourism work touching Sápmi has these bodies as counterparts.

An ethical framework already exists. Sápmi is the one part of this mapping with agreed ethical rules for tourism. In 2018 the Sámi Parliament in Finland adopted a set of principles. They cover responsible and ethically sustainable Sámi tourism. Its stated purpose is to end tourism that exploits Sámi culture. A second aim is to remove incorrect information about the Sámi spread through tourism. The guidelines are addressed to operators outside the Sámi community (Sámi Parliament of Finland, ethical guidelines). The same parliament publishes a Responsible Visitors' Guide for people travelling in the Sámi homeland. A certification for operators is in development, funded through NextGenerationEU (Sámi Parliament of Finland, responsible Sámi tourism).

In Norway, Sametinget has its own definition of Sámi tourism. It is tourism where Sámi cultural elements form the main element of the business. Sametinget wants businesses that present Sámi culture in a way Sámi people recognise themselves in. It also runs a grant scheme for Sámi tourism, creative industries and Sámi food (Sametinget Norway, Sámi tourism).

Food-specific initiatives. Slow Food Sápmi is the clearest one. Founded in 2009, it spans the Sámi areas of Sweden, Norway, Finland and Russia. It works as an industry organisation for Sámi food processing and Sámi restaurants. Its work covers competence development, advice and business development (Slow Food Sápmi). The Njalle project documents traditional Sámi food in order to develop Sámi cuisine. A food truck tours Sápmi with workshops for chefs and small-scale producers. The book Smak på Sápmi came out of work between chefs and producers (Slow Food Sápmi).

In Sweden, Renlycka is a quality label for Sámi reindeer meat. It requires natural grazing and Sámi ownership through the whole production chain (Renlycka). Sametinget in Sweden has also set out a Sámi food vision (Sametinget Sweden, Sámi food vision).

What this means for the project. Two things follow. First, the ethical groundwork already exists, and it was written by the people concerned. It is a resource for the project, not an obstacle. Second, Sápmi is cross-border by nature. That makes it a natural fit for Nordic cooperation rather than national work. The condition is that Sámi bodies are counterparts, not subject matter.

> ***Knowledge gap:*** *This section has not been reviewed by a Sámi body. Corrections from the Sámi Parliaments or the Saami Council take precedence over what is written here.*

3.11 The dominant Nordic narrative today

This section steps back out to the Nordic region as a whole. It describes the communicative narratives that already dominate Nordic food tourism today. Designing the project's own shared Nordic narrative comes later (Outcome 1.3) and is not done here.

Three narratives keep recurring across the material. The most prominent is food and drink as a reason to travel in its own right. Where communication positions the place through taste, stories, people and setting, rather than describing a product or a meal on its own (Visit Sweden, storytelling; Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.). Close behind is authenticity: Nordic communication tends to foreground the local, the small-scale and the place-bound, where travellers are expected to meet the origin of the ingredients, the craft behind the food and the people who produce it (Visit Sweden, storytelling; Smak63, storytelling). The third is sustainability, where food tourism is tied to rural development, local value chains and long-term place development, especially visible in cross-border projects, where food becomes a tool for building a region's attractiveness and resilience, not just something

visitors consume (Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.).

The emphasis shifts from country to country. Sweden has the most developed communicative framework, with clear storytelling, audience segmentation and inspiration for businesses to package experiences, usually aimed at making the experience bookable, understandable and attractive to international travellers (Visit Sweden, the food travellers; Visit Sweden, storytelling). Visit Sweden also leans on nature as a spice. That means healthy, natural ingredients from the forests and the sea. The Edible Country campaign of 2019 made the idea concrete (Visit Sweden, the Edible Country). In cross-border projects between Sweden and Norway, the narrative turns more cultural and historical, leaning on culinary heritage, tradition and collaboration across borders, and reads as more place-anchored and less export-driven than the national Swedish line (Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.). Finland leans into a strategic sustainability narrative, tying food tourism to regional development and responsible local food systems, while Denmark is more destination- and event-led, folding gastro tourism into a broader destination appeal (Food Tourism Strategy of Finland 2020-2028; Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0, 2024-2027; Visit Finland, Nordic marketing comparison 2025).

A 2025 marketing comparison from Visit Finland sharpens this picture considerably. It reviewed the tourism websites and social channels of Sweden, Denmark and Norway. The social media review covered January 2024 to May 2025. Finland and the capital cities were included for comparison. The finding is blunt. The three countries say almost the same things about food. Local and seasonal provenance, food from pure nature, and the rhythm of the seasons. Sustainability, tradition and local culture recur in all three. All three address culture travellers and eco-conscious visitors above all. Family travel gets less attention everywhere (Visit Finland, Nordic marketing comparison 2025).

What separates them is not the message but the delivery. The comparison concludes that differentiation comes mostly from tone of voice. And from a handful of signature foods and experiences. Sweden is calm, poetic and inclusive, built around fika and foraging. Denmark is humorous and everyday, mixing Michelin with hot dogs. Norway is informal and adventurous, with food anchored in dramatic landscape. Finland reads as practical, factual and minimalistic (Visit Finland, Nordic marketing comparison 2025).

The consumer data points the same way. Travellers associate Nordic flavours and fresh game and fish with all four countries. Other food associations are rare anywhere (Visit Finland, image study 2025).

Across the Nordic region, this comes down to one shared idea, told in different ways: the food tells the story of the place, the local signals authenticity, and a sustainable experience strengthens both destination and industry. This shared foundation is a starting point, and it is also a warning. The countries are not only aligned. They are hard to tell apart. How they bring this together into one Nordic narrative is a question for later project activities.

4. Challenges and potentials for the project

This chapter draws the country pictures in chapter 3 together. It asks what they mean for the project, not for food tourism in general. Three lenses guide the analysis: strategy and policy, incentives, and preconditions. A fourth section looks at what the lenses add up to. The eight start from very different places when it comes to a shared story. The chapter closes with two lists. The challenges the project should plan for, and the potentials it can build on.

4.1 Strategy and policy

Five of the eight have an explicit food tourism strategy or a funded national initiative. Sweden works through Food Strategy 2.0 and Visit Sweden's knowledge assignment for 2025-2027 (Jordbruksverket, food strategy; Visit Sweden, 2025-2027 assignment). Denmark makes food tourism a stated priority in its national tourism strategy. It delivers that priority through Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0 (Visit Denmark, strategy 2023-2026; Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0). Norway has Matnasjonen Norge, backed by three ministries (Matnasjonen Norge, 2021). Finland has run a national food tourism strategy since 2020, now refreshed for 2024-2028 (Finland's Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028). Åland has a dedicated taste tourism strategy, Ålands Smakturismstrategi 2025-2030 (Åland, national section review, 2026).

Three have no dedicated strategy, but the reasons differ. Greenland places food inside its ten-year tourism strategy (Visit Greenland, strategy 2025-2035). The Faroe Islands has no food tourism strategy. Yet food is one of five brand pillars at Visit Faroe Islands (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026). Iceland has no dedicated food tourism strategy either. But food culture is written into its Tourism Strategy 2030. Action E.1 makes culture one of two main pillars, alongside nature (Iceland, Tourism Strategy 2030).

Where the strategy sits also varies. In Åland, neither strategy sits inside the tourism organisation. The older food strategy is being revised by Ålands landskapsregering. In Finland, much development work sits with Hungry for Finland, not with Visit Finland.

So strategic maturity is genuinely uneven, not just unevenly documented. Some partners have worked strategically with food tourism for years. Others have real activity but no policy home for it.

4.2 Incentives

Where a national initiative exists, money is already flowing. Each funding line has its own logic and timeline.

- **Sweden.** Jordbruksverket's SEK 40 million call funds a toolkit for place development and regional pilots. It runs to January 2028 (Jordbruksverket, food tourism call). Visit

Sweden's knowledge assignment runs in parallel for 2025-2027 (Visit Sweden, 2025-2027 assignment). The largest investments have been regional, not national. EU regional funds and the county administrative boards carry most of them (Visit Sweden, national section review, 2026).

- **Finland.** Visit Finland's food image project has EUR 2 million for 2025-2027. The Ministry of Agriculture and Forestry funds it. Hungry for Finland's competition and tools run largely on EU project funding (Visit Finland, national section review, 2026).

- **Denmark.** The Danish Business Promotion Board funds Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0 to 2027 (Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0). A proposed DKK 40 million food initiative awaits a decision from the new minister.

- **Norway.** Norway has set a target of NOK 25 billion in local food sales by 2035 (Innovation Norway, national section review, 2026).

- **Åland.** The EU co-finances Smakturismen på Åland for 2024-2027 (Åland, national section review, 2026).

Political priority is an incentive too, even without a budget line. The Faroe Islands now trains chefs at home, rather than abroad, as a political priority. The Faroese political debate also turns to food self-sufficiency and resilience (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026). Greenland is investing in new airports, which should lift hotels and restaurants (Visit Greenland, strategy 2025-2035). Iceland's tourism strategy estimates ISK 15 million a year for cultural tourism marketing. That covers culture as a whole, not food tourism alone (Iceland, Tourism Strategy 2030).

For the project, incentives do not have to be invented. Money and political will already point towards local food, place development and international visibility. But the timelines do not line up. National initiatives end in 2027, 2028, 2030 or 2035. And each funding line serves its own national goals first. A shared Nordic narrative has to fit alongside them, not compete with them.

4.3 Preconditions

Preconditions decide who the project can actually work with. Chapter 3 shows four ways of organising food and tourism. They matter less as structures than as doors into each country.

One door. Norway has fused the two sectors in Innovation Norway. One partner covers food and tourism at once. That makes coordination simple and the Norwegian voice coherent (Innovation Norway, local food and experiences).

A project-based bridge. Denmark keeps the sectors apart but joins some of them, project by project. Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0 is the current example. The bridge exists because someone built it, not because the structure provided it (Danmarks Maddestinationer

2.0).

Many doors. Sweden, Finland and Åland spread the work across several bodies. In Finland the marketing partner is not the development partner. In Åland three organisations hold different pieces. In Sweden the landscape is broader still, and regional bodies carry much of the work.

No separate door yet. The Faroe Islands and Greenland fold food into the destination organisation. Iceland keeps tourism and food as separate export sectors inside Business Iceland. Cooperation between the two is developing, but it is recent (Business Iceland, national section review, 2026).

Three consequences follow for the project.

First, one invitation list will not work across the eight. Where a single partner covers both sectors, one contact is enough. Where the work is spread, the project needs several contacts per country. The target of sixty actors from both sectors depends on getting that right (Project application, 2026).

Second, structure does not predict activity. The Faroe Islands has no food unit, yet activity is high. An accelerator, a chef education and home dining all run there. Iceland looked quiet from the outside, but its work was simply not documented openly. Reading structure as ambition would misjudge both.

Third, the project cannot change these structures, and should not try. It can work with them, by adapting how it invites, informs and follows up.

Regulation is a further precondition, named here without developing it. The eight sit in different regulatory environments for food, drink and labelling. Changing that regulation is not part of this project. It is context for what a joint approach can realistically build on.

4.4 Different starting points for a shared narrative

The three lenses add up to one finding. The countries do not only stand at different levels. They are also likely to need a shared Nordic narrative in different ways.

Some already have a strong, explicit national food identity. Gastronomy is one of Visit Denmark's three core narratives (Visit Denmark, strategy 2023-2026). Sweden has the most developed communicative framework in the region (Visit Sweden, storytelling).

Others are far less visible abroad. Finnish food is barely known outside Finland. Finland also trails the other Nordic countries on consideration as a destination (Visit Finland, image study 2025). A shared Nordic story is likely to matter more where national visibility is weaker. Where it is already strong, the shared story has to add something, not replace it.

Yet the stories themselves are strikingly similar. Visit Finland found that Sweden, Denmark and Norway say nearly the same things about food. What separates them is mainly tone of voice (Visit Finland, Nordic marketing comparison 2025).

Sápmi adds a further dimension. Sámi food culture crosses the borders of three Nordic countries. Sámi Parliaments in Finland and Norway already set out principles for Sámi tourism (Sámi Parliament of Finland, ethical guidelines; Sametinget Norway, Sámi tourism). How Sápmi appears in a shared story is decided together with Sámi partners.

So the project cannot assume one need. A shared narrative has to be usable for partners with a strong national food identity. It also has to work for partners still building one. Chapter 6 returns to what this means for the narrative.

4.5 Challenges for the project

The challenges are not that some countries are behind. They are that the eight are unlike each other. Those differences matter for joint work.

One project, eight starting points. A single template will fit no one well. Partners with an eight-year strategy need something different from partners without a policy home. The risk is a lowest common denominator that satisfies nobody. Differentiated entry points cost more effort, but they are what makes participation real.

The shared story is not equally needed. For some partners it competes with a strong national story. For others it is the only story reaching international audiences. If the project designs for one of these groups, it loses the other. The narrative work has to prove its value in both directions.

Similar stories, different voices. The national stories already overlap heavily, and differ mainly in tone. A Nordic narrative that simply averages them adds nothing. It has to say something the national stories cannot say alone.

Calendars the project does not control. National initiatives run on their own funding cycles, ending between 2027 and 2035. The project cannot move them. It has to time its own deliverables to fit windows that already exist.

Structure is not the same as capacity. Where food has no organisational home, activity can still be high. Desk research underestimated several partners until they described their own work. The project should judge partners by what they do, not by how they are organised.

Work that rarely crosses a border. Chapter 3 is full of initiatives unknown outside their own country. Accelerators, chef training, local food brands and home dining all qualify. Little of it reaches the others in a form they can use. The project can change that, but only with somewhere to put it.

4.6 Potentials for the project

• **Ready-made scaffolding at Nordic level.** New Nordic Food 2025-2027 gives the project a food sector counterpart. It also offers a Nordic convening structure to plug into. Madkulturen runs it with a set of very different food partners. The counterpart exists, but it is not one single voice.

• **Money and momentum already in motion.** Sweden, Denmark, Norway, Finland and Åland all fund work towards overlapping goals. The project can align with that momentum rather than duplicate it.

• **Evidence that the food traveller is worth more.** Norway's food tourists spend more per day and rate their trip higher (Innovation Norway, Tourism Survey 2025). In Denmark, 41 per cent of tourists chose the country partly for its food. They also spend more per day than the average guest (Visit Denmark, food and gastro tourists, 2025). Finland's image study shows food ranks second among travel themes globally (Visit Finland, image study 2025). No shared Nordic evidence base exists yet. Building one would give every partner a stronger case at home.

• **Live examples of transfer between countries.** Heimablídni, dining in Faroese homes, is now being tested in Norway (Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026). M.A.T. already links Sweden and Norway across the border (Interreg Sverige-Norge, M.A.T.). Knowledge already moves between Nordic countries. The project can make that happen more often, and on purpose.

• **A working model to learn from.** Norway's fused tourism and food organisation shows what the cross-sector bridge can look like. It is worth studying directly.

• **Ambition in less expected places.** Åland has a dedicated taste tourism strategy outside its tourism organisation. Its food strategy is being revised right now, which makes the timing good. Greenland's new airports and growing food scene open another window (Visit Greenland, strategy 2025-2035).

• **A stronger link between food and tourism, in its own right.** Beyond any single initiative, the clearest potential is closer work between the two sectors. That is the bridge this project exists to build.

5. Recommendations from earlier projects

The region does not start from zero. Earlier Nordic work already turned analysis into guidance. This chapter gathers what is worth carrying forward. It is a synthesis, not a new set of proposals.

The 2022 Nordic vision. The Nordic Food in Tourism 2019-2021 project set out a common vision. Visiting the Nordics should mean experiencing people and planet prospering together. It translated into six focus areas (Matís, Nordic Food in Future Tourism, 2022).

- **Investment and lobbying.** Build political attention for food in tourism, and a Nordic funding system for it.
- **Tools and knowledge for innovation.** Share a framework for product development, with regional clusters and joint Nordic hackathons.
- **Understanding residents and visitors.** Research travel behaviour and consumption, and give visitors guidance on lowering their footprint.
- **Education and training.** Invest in schools and businesses, and consider a new profession, the Nordic food tourism designer.
- **A communication toolkit.** Build it on a shared Nordic lifestyle and gastronomy. Use it across the whole visitor economy.
- **Visibility and distribution of local food.** Make local food easy to find, origin-labelled and tied to local food festivities.

Two national examples. Sweden distilled its ambition into one target for 2030. Local food experiences should be sustainable, innovative and a prominent part of the destination (Visit Sweden, action plan 2022). Finland shows the other half of the picture. Its strategy runs on seven action areas. It was built through sixteen workshops and input from entrepreneurs (Finland's Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028).

What this means here. Several of these ideas map onto the project's own activities. The networking and hackathon ideas sit close to Outcome 1.2. The communication toolkit is raw material for Outcome 1.3. The call for shared product development tools points straight at Outcome 1.4. What is missing is the sustained follow-through the 2022 report itself flagged. Closing that gap is what this project is for.

6. Conclusions, gaps and starting points

This chapter closes the report. It sums up what the mapping shows. And it sets out where the project goes from here.

6.1 What the mapping shows

Food tourism is active across the Nordic region. Six findings stand out.

First, strategic maturity differs. Five of the eight have a food tourism strategy or a funded national initiative. Greenland and the Faroe Islands work with food in other ways. Greenland uses its tourism strategy, the Faroe Islands a brand pillar. Iceland writes food culture into its tourism strategy, with culture as a main pillar.

Second, money and political will are already in motion. But the timelines run from 2027 to 2035, and each serves national goals first.

Third, food and tourism are organised very differently. Norway has fused them. Elsewhere they sit in two or three separate homes.

Fourth, the countries are likely to need a shared narrative in different ways. Some already have a strong national food identity. Others are barely visible abroad. Yet their food stories are strikingly similar.

Fifth, where the food traveller has been measured, the segment is worth more. Norway, Denmark and Finland all point the same way. No shared Nordic evidence base exists yet.

Sixth, much of this work never crosses a border. The countries rarely hear what the others are doing.

One more thing is worth saying plainly. Most of this picture came from the partners themselves. Open sources alone understated what several countries are doing. That is an argument for the networking activities, and for a digital home.

6.2 Starting points for the project

One principle runs through everything that follows. Every project activity must have a practical use. A report, a narrative or a catalogue is not an end in itself. Each is only worth making if people can use it in their own work. The project is responsible for making that happen, for all eight countries and territories. It cannot leave that task to the partners. So every deliverable faces the same test. Who will use it, and for what?

The mapping shows why this matters. The partners stand at different levels. They are also likely to need a shared narrative in different ways. That gives the project three clear starting points.

The narrative. The narrative (Outcome 1.3) must be usable by all eight, whatever their starting point. It has to add something where a national food identity is already strong. And it has to lift those who are less visible abroad. Sápmi is part of the story, and it is told together with Sámi partners.

The catalogue. The catalogue (Outcome 1.4) is a separate deliverable about product development. It gathers good examples from across the region, so partners can learn from each other. This report does not design the catalogue. It shows why it is needed.

The network. The networking activities (Outcome 1.2) are where the partners meet around this work. Knowledge already moves between Nordic countries, as chapter 4 showed. Through the network, that exchange becomes regular rather than occasional.

A digital home. The project needs one place where its work lives and stays current. Partners have to find the narrative, the catalogue and the examples without asking for them. They also have to pass material on to their own regions and partners. A document sent by email dates quickly and is easily lost. It can be the project's own home, or part of Nordic co-operation's existing channels. It also gives every partner fair and equal access to the work. Either way, it is a condition for the work to outlive the project period.

The report has laid the ground. The work now is to build on it, in ways all eight can use.

Appendix: References

In-text citations use a short parenthetical form (author or organisation, year). Full references are listed below, grouped to follow the structure of the report. This list is updated as further chapters are drafted.

Definitions

World Food Travel Association, what is food tourism. Cited for its definition of food tourism.
https://www.worldfoodtravel.org/food-tourism

Project and Nordic framework

Project application, 2026. Nordic Food Tourism 2026-2027, Project Description (Project ID 437). Visit Denmark / Nordic Council of Ministers.

Nordic Food Tourism, presentation, June 2026. Project overview, Nordic Food Tourism 2026-2027.

Matís, Nordic Food in Future Tourism, 2022. Laxdal, B., Valsdóttir, Þ. & Sigurjónsdóttir, Á. K. Matís report 11-22, in collaboration with the Ministry of Culture and Business Affairs and the Icelandic Tourism Cluster. Funded by the Nordic Council of Ministers. Final report of Nordic Food in Tourism 2019-2021.
https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.6322798

Nordic Tourism Plan 2025-2030. Nordic Council of Ministers, plan for Nordic tourism cooperation. Published March 2025, publication no. 2025:709.
https://www.norden.org/en/publication/nordic-tourism-plan-2025-2030

Madkulturen, Ny nordisk mad – en madbevægelse gennem 20 år, 2024. Analysis of the New Nordic Food Manifesto's impact after twenty years, commissioned by the Nordic Council of Ministers, presented 24 April 2024. Based on interviews with manifesto signatories, a survey of 88 participants in cross-sectoral dialogue meetings, interviews with retail and food entrepreneurs, and a media analysis of coverage from 2004-2023.

New Nordic Food Manifesto, 2004. Nordic cooperation.
https://www.norden.org/en/information/new-nordic-food-manifesto

New Nordic Food programme. Nordic Council of Ministers.
https://www.norden.org/en/new-nordic-food

Updating the New Nordic Food Movement. Nordic cooperation.
https://www.norden.org/en/news/updating-new-nordic-food-movement-win-win

The Nordic Council of Ministers' political priorities 2025-2030.
https://www.norden.org/en/nordic-council-ministers-political-priorities-2025-2030

Brand Finance, Global Soft Power Index, 2026. Annual survey of perceptions of *nation brands, over 170,000 respondents in more than 100 countries. Covers the 193*

UN member states only, which is why the Nordic self-governing areas cannot appear

in it. Cited in 3.1 as an example of state-based international measurement.

https://brandfinance.com/press-releases/nordic-nations-global-soft-power-continues-to-benefit-from-sustainability-metrics

Sweden

Visit Sweden, Sveriges måltidsturism – idag och i framtiden, 2022. National strategic action plan for Swedish food tourism (final delivery of the export programme for food tourism 2017-2022).

Visit Sweden, knowledge and analysis assignment (2025-2027).
https://corporate.visitsweden.com/om-oss/projekt-och-event/kunskap-och-analys-inom-maltidsturism/

Visit Sweden, food tourism programme 2017-2022.
https://corporate.visitsweden.com/kunskap/maltidsturism/maltidsprogrammet-2017-2022/

Jordbruksverket, funding call for Swedish food tourism (SEK 40 million).
https://jordbruksverket.se/stod/utlysningar-och-upphandlingar/2024/projekt-som-framjar-samarbete-for-utvecklingen-av-svensk-maltidsturism

Visit Sweden becomes a wholly state-owned company (2020).
https://corporate.visitsweden.com/press/visit-sweden-blir-helstatligt-bolag/

Visit Sweden, food tourism knowledge hub.
https://corporate.visitsweden.com/kunskap/maltidsturism/

Jordbruksverket, food strategy for Sweden.
https://jordbruksverket.se/mat-och-drycker/livsmedelsstrategi-for-sverige

Government assignment to Jordbruksverket under Food Strategy 2.0 (2025-2030).
https://www.regeringen.se/regeringsuppdrag/2025/03/uppdrag-till-statens-jordbruksverk-att-genomfora-atgarder-under-perioden-20252030-inom-ramen-for-livsmedelsstrategin-2.0

Tillväxtverket, coordination assignment within the food strategy.
https://tillvaxtverket.se/tillvaxtverket/seminarierochnatverk/natverkochsamverkan/allanatverk/samordningsuppdragetinomlivsmedelsstrategin.3925.html

Visit Skåne, food and drink in Skåne.
https://corporate.visitskane.com/sv/om-oss/destinationsutveckling/mat-dryck-i-skane

Turistrådet Västsverige, Smaka på Västsverige.
https://www.vastsverige.com/turistradet-vastsverige/artiklar/maltiden-som-reseanledning/

Visit Sweden, national section review, 2026. Written comments from Visit Sweden on the Swedish national section, received 18 September 2026.

Tillväxtverket, project bank. Database of EU-funded regional projects, including food tourism projects.
https://tillvaxtverket.se/tillvaxtverket/sokfinansiering/finansieradeprojekt/projektbanken.5715.html

Tillväxtverket, Hallands Matgille. Regional food tourism project in Halland, financed by the European Regional Development Fund and Region Halland, 2018-2022.
https://tillvaxtverket.se/tillvaxtverket/sokfinansiering/finansieradeprojekt/finansieradeprojekteu/hallandsmatgillestottardenlokalproduceratematen.2736.html

Norway

M.A.T. – Måltidsupplevelser, Autenticitet & Tradition (Interreg Sverige-Norge).
https://www.interreg-sverige-norge.com/projekt/mat-måltidsupplevelser-autenticitet-tradition/

Matnasjonen Norge, strategy (2021). Norwegian Ministry of Agriculture and Food, Ministry of Trade and Industry, and Ministry of Health and Care Services.
https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/4934157014d94e3986b2219111bdf806/matnasjonen-norge_strategi_uu.pdf

Innovation Norway, local food and experiences.
https://www.innovasjonnorge.no/artikkel/lokalmat-og-opplevelser

Innovation Norway, tourism.
https://reiseliv.innovasjonnorge.no/

Innovation Norway, Tourism Survey 2025 (Turistundersøkelsen). Theme 2: accommodation, holiday type and package travel. Slide on tourists who have sought out food experiences (n = 5 214 food tourists, n = 12 637 all foreign leisure travellers). Shared with the project by Innovation Norway, August 2026.

Innovation Norway, national section review, 2026. Written comments on the Norwegian national section of this report, received 25 August 2026.

Innovation Norway, pilot for local food in public procurement (2025).
https://kommunikasjon.ntb.no/pressemelding/18395449/innovasjon-norge-stotter-nytt-pilotprosjekt-for-norsk-lokalmat

HANEN at Internationale Grüne Woche (IGW) 2026, Berlin.
https://www.hanen.no/hanen-pa-igw-verdens-storste-mat-og-landbruksmesse/

Finland

Food Tourism Strategy of Finland 2020-2028 (summary).
https://www.hungryforfinland.fi/files/2021/09/Summary-Food-Tourism-Strategy-of-Finland-2020-2028.pdf

Food Tourism Strategy of Finland 2024-2028 (presentation, Haaga-Helia).
https://www.haaga-helia.fi/sites/default/files/file/2024-12/presentation-food-tourism-strategy-finland-2024-2028-hungry-for-finland-en.pdf

Finland's Food Tourism Strategy 2024-2028 (Haaga-Helia article).
https://www.haaga-helia.fi/en/current/articles/finlands-food-tourism-strategy-2024-2028

Hungry for Finland (H4F), Haaga-Helia.
https://www.haaga-helia.fi/en/hungry-finland-food-responsibly-part-finnish-tourism

Hungry for Finland Food Tourism Competition 2026.
https://www.haaga-helia.fi/en/rdi-projects/hungry-finland-food-tourism-competition-2026

Visit Finland, national section review, 2026. Comments from Visit Finland on the draft national section, September 2026. Covers the role of Hungry for Finland, the regions most active in marketing, the scope, budget and timeline of the food image project, the regional core groups and Finland's presence at Nordic events.

Visit Finland, food image and food tourism awareness project (2025-2027).

https://www.visitfinland.fi/liiketoiminnan-kehittaminen/yhteistyoprojektit/ruokamaakuvan-ja-ruokamatkailun-tunnettuus--projekti/

Archipelago Sea food, tourism and biodiversity initiative.

https://finland.representation.ec.europa.eu/uutiset-ja-tapahtumat/uutiset/saaristomeren-hyvinvointi-alkaa-matkailijan-aamiaislautaselta-2026-04-28_sv

Visit Finland, image study 2025. Study on the attractiveness of Finland as a destination for tourism and food tourism in 2025. Quantitative online survey, fieldwork 3 to 30 July 2025. Markets: Germany, Spain, France, the USA and Japan. 5,060 respondents aged 18 to 65 planning a leisure trip abroad or to Europe within three years. Summary report and five country reports supplied by Visit Finland, September 2026.

Visit Finland, country reports 2025. Finland as a food tourism destination, one report per market.

https://www.visitfinland.fi/globalassets/visitfinland.fi/vf-julkaisut/2025/finland-as-a-food-tourism-destination-france-country-report.pdf

https://www.visitfinland.fi/globalassets/visitfinland.fi/vf-julkaisut/2025/finland-as-a-food-tourism-destination-germany-country-report.pdf

https://www.visitfinland.fi/globalassets/visitfinland.fi/vf-julkaisut/2025/finland-as-a-food-tourism-destination-japan-country-report.pdf

https://www.visitfinland.fi/globalassets/visitfinland.fi/vf-julkaisut/2025/finland-as-a-food-tourism-destination-spain-country-report.pdf

https://www.visitfinland.fi/globalassets/visitfinland.fi/vf-julkaisut/2025/finland-as-a-food-tourism-destination-usa-country-report.pdf

Visit Finland, Nordic marketing comparison 2025. Comparing Nordic food tourism marketing. Competitor analysis of the tourism websites and social media channels of Sweden, Denmark and Norway, with Finland and the capital cities included for comparison. Social media review period January 2024 to May 2025.

https://www.visitfinland.fi/globalassets/visitfinland.fi/vf-julkaisut/2025/comparing-nordic-food-tourism-marketing-2025.pdf

Denmark

Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0 (2024-2027).

https://landdistrikterne.dk/projekt/danmarks-maddestinationer-2-0/

Danmarks Maddestinationer 2.0, partner page (Sydsjælland & Møn).

https://www.sydsjaellandmoen.dk/corporate/projekter/danmarks-maddestinationer

Visit Denmark, strategy 2023-2026 ("Turisme vi kan leve af og leve med mod 2030").

https://www.visitdenmark.dk/sites/visitdenmark.com/files/2023-05/VDK%20strategi%202023-2026.pdf

Visit Denmark, food and gastro tourists in Denmark, 2025.

https://www.visitdenmark.dk/corporate/videncenter/mad-og-gastroturister-i-danmark

Visit Denmark, Gastro 2025 campaign (2019-2022), results.

https://www.visitdenmark.dk/corporate/om-os/dansk-gastronomi-er-et-hit

Visit Denmark, gastronomy initiative 2019-2022.

https://www.visitdenmark.dk/corporate/aktiviteter/gastro

Falstaff, 2026. Coverage of the Danish Minister of Culture's first steps towards recognising gastronomy as an artistic discipline. *Full reference to be completed.*

Alchemist, press report. Media coverage results from the five-day chefs' gathering in Copenhagen hosted by Rasmus Munk and the Alchemist team. *Full reference to be completed.*

Iceland

https://www.visiticeland.com/article/enjoy-icelandic-food

https://www.visiticeland.com/article/traditional-icelandic-food-guide

Business Iceland (Íslandsstofa), Act of Business Iceland.
https://www.islandsstofa.is/en/act-of-business-iceland/

Business Iceland, tourism as a key sector.
https://www.islandsstofa.is/en/key-sectors-tourism/

Ferðamálastofa, Icelandic Tourist Board, about us.
https://www.ferdamalastofa.is/en/about-us-1/icelandic-tourist-board

Iceland, Tourism Strategy 2030 (Ferðamálastefna til 2030). Icelandic national tourism policy. Actions C.1 and C.2 on cultural character and authentic experiences, pages 44 to 45. Action E.1 on culture as a main pillar and food culture in tourism promotion, page 70, with an estimated annual allocation of ISK 15 million for cultural tourism marketing as a whole. Illustrative business profiles on pages 33 and 81.
https://www.stjornarradid.is/library/?itemid=f943ebac-e3b9-11ef-b88e-005056bcde1f

Business Iceland, national section review, 2026. Written comments and supplementary information from Business Iceland on the Icelandic national section, received 30 September 2026.

Business Iceland, about. Homepage and marketing projects.
https://www.islandsstofa.is/en/marketing-projects/

Business Iceland, Taste of Iceland London, 2026. Report from the event in London, September 2026.
https://www.islandsstofa.is/en/news/taste-of-iceland-london-debuts-sold-out-crowds/

Business Iceland, Matarferðaþjónusta, 2021. Announcement of the Nordic Food in Tourism conference at Hotel Valaskjálf, 30 September 2021, and Austurbrú's Matarmót the following day.
https://www.islandsstofa.is/vidburdir/matarferdathjonusta-okkur-ad-godu-a-austurlandi/

Åland

Åland, national section review, 2026. Written response to the Ålandic national section of this report, received August 2026.

Ålands hållbara livsmedelsstrategi (2017). Åland's sustainable food strategy, produced by Ålands Producentförbund in collaboration with several other organisations. Described by the partner in 2026 as out of date and currently under revision by Ålands landskapsregering.
https://landsbygd.ax/livsmedelsstrategin/

Ålands Landsbygdscentrum, statistics on rural industries. Annual reports with summary statistics on Åland's rural industries and food production, published as downloadable PDFs.

https://landsbygd.ax/landsbygdsnaringarna-pa-aland/

Ålands Smakturismstrategi 2025-2030. Åland's taste tourism strategy, produced by the project Smakturismen på Åland (2024-2027), owned by Högskolan på Åland and co-financed by the EU.

Åland, sustainable food strategy summary (EU Tourism Transition Pathways).
https://transition-pathways.europa.eu/tourism/knowledge-documents/aland-sets-its-sights-becoming-leading-food-tourism-destination-new

Ålands Landsbygdscentrum, current updates on the food strategy.
https://landsbygd.ax/tag/livsmedelsstrategi_nyheter/

Visit Åland, cooperation with Visit Finland.
https://news.cision.com/se/visit-aland/r/visit-alands-samarbete-med-visit-finland-bar-frukt-igen,c2354827

Högskolan på Åland, research and collaboration projects.
https://www.ha.ax/forskning-samverkan/projekt/

The Faroe Islands

Visit Faroe Islands, about us.
https://visitfaroeislands.com/en/meetings/our-services/about-us

Visit Faroe Islands, Tourism Strategy 2030 (HEIM).
https://visitfaroeislands.com/en/about-vfi/about0/tourism-strategy-20300

Visit Faroe Islands, national section review, 2026. Comments from Visit Faroe Islands on the draft national section, September 2026. Covers food as a brand pillar, the accelerator Nýskapan í Ferðavinnu, the chef education, Rótin, Veltan, Heimablídni and Arctic Young Chefs.

Visit Faroe Islands, Faroese food.
https://visitfaroeislands.com/en/about-vfi/people-society/faroese-food

Visit Faroe Islands, Heimablídni.
https://visitfaroeislands.com/en/see-do/cultural-experiences/eat-and-drink/heimablidni

Mat- og tilfeingishúsið, iNOVA. Food and resource centre at the iNOVA research park in Tórshavn.
https://www.inova.fo/?_l=en

Rótin, Klaksvík. Link supplied in the partner review.
https://www.norden.org/en/nominee/rotin-faroe-islands

Veltan, Sandoy. Link supplied in the partner review.
https://www.facebook.com/felagidveltan

Greenland

Visit Greenland, about the organisation.
https://traveltrade.visitgreenland.com/about-the-organization/

Visit Greenland, Strategy 2025-2035.
https://traveltrade.visitgreenland.com/strategy/

Visit Greenland, national section review, 2026. Written response to the Greenlandic national section of this report, received August 2026.

Visit Greenland, list of destination management organisations.
https://traveltrade.visitgreenland.com/list-of-dmos-in-greenland/

NAPA, New Arctic Kitchen. Nordic Arctic initiative connecting food and tourism, including an inspiration guide on food tourism for tourism operators.
https://napa.gl/da/new-arctic-kitchen-lokal-mad-fra-arktis-paa-nye-maader/

Innovation South Greenland (ISG), tourism.
https://isg.gl/en/business-sectors/tourism/

Innovation South Greenland (ISG), food.
https://isg.gl/da/brancher/foedevare/

Innovation South Greenland, report on Inuit food (2026).
https://survivingsealingstigma.com/2026/02/16/inuit-food-new-report-from-innovation-south-greenland/

Inuili, Greenland's national food and hospitality college.
https://inuili.gl/

Sisimiut Fresh Farms. Vertical farming and hydroponics in Sisimiut, founded 2023.
https://sisimiutfreshfarm.com/

Forbes, From Fjords to Fine Dining: Inside the Rise of Greenlandic Cuisine (2025).
https://www.forbes.com/sites/jordilippemcgraw/2025/04/24/from-fjords-to-fine-dining-inside-the-rise-of-greenlandic-cuisine/

National Geographic, gourmet trip to Greenland.
https://www.nationalgeographic.com/travel/article/gourmet-trip-to-greenland-new-arctic-cuisine

Sápmi

Sámi Parliament of Finland, ethical guidelines. Principles for Responsible and Ethically Sustainable Sámi Tourism, adopted 24 September 2018.
https://samediggi.fi/en/areas-of-expertise/livelihoods-justice-and-environment/ethical-guidelines-for-sami-tourism/

Sámi Parliament of Finland, responsible Sámi tourism. Includes the Responsible Visitors' Guide to the World of Sámi Culture and Sámi Homeland in Finland, and a certificate for operators under development, funded through NextGenerationEU.
https://samediggi.fi/en/areas-of-expertise/livelihoods-justice-and-environment/responsible-sami-tourism/

Responsible Visitors' Guide to the World of Sámi Culture and Sámi Homeland in Finland.
https://matkailu.samediggi.fi/en/

Sametinget Norway, Sámi tourism. Definition of Sámi tourism and grant scheme for Sámi tourism, creative industries and Sámi food.
https://sametinget.no/naring/samisk-reiseliv/

Slow Food Sápmi. Sámi industry organisation for food processing and restaurants, founded 2009, covering the Sámi areas of Sweden, Norway, Finland and Russia.
https://www.slowfoodsapmi.com/om-oss/

Renlycka. Quality label for Sámi reindeer meat in Sweden, requiring natural grazing and Sámi ownership through the production chain.
https://renlycka.se/

Sametinget Sweden, Sámi food vision.
https://sametinget.se/4714

Communicative narratives (current state)

M.A.T., food tourism in central Scandinavia strengthens the visitor economy (Interreg Sverige-Norge).
https://www.interreg-sverige-norge.com/m-a-t-maltidsturism-i-centrala-skandinavien-starker-besoksnaringen/

Visit Sweden, storytelling, the art of communicating memorable meal experiences.
https://corporate.visitsweden.com/kunskap/maltidsturism/storytelling-konsten-att-kommunicera-minnesvarda-maltidsupplevelser/

Smak63, storytelling as communication that elevates meal experiences.
https://www.smak63.com/inspiration/storytelling-kommunikation-som-forhojer-maltidsupplevelser

Visit Sweden, the food travellers (Region Örebro län).
https://orta.regionorebrolan.se/contentassets/f333a23649e74885a0529b3666dfbdb0/visit-sweden-maltidsresenarerna.pdf

Visit Sweden, report review, 2026. Comments from Visit Sweden on an early version of this report, September 2026. Covers nature as a spice, how food travellers from priority markets perceive Sweden, and regional stakeholders.

Visit Sweden, the Edible Country.
https://visitsweden.com/edible-country/